



Leash Reactivity Reset

Threshold Guide



FITDOG TRAINING ACADEMY

Thresholds

Distance first. Learning second.

Dogs can only learn when they are not overwhelmed.

TRAINER NOTE

Stay below threshold. Distance and safety come before performance.

Start here

Dog's name

Date

Owner

Best reward

Distance first

Your dog learns when they can notice and still think.

Soft leash

Create space early. Tension raises arousal.

Mark calm

Reward looking, sniffing, and disengaging.

1 Training goal

YOUR GOAL THIS WEEK

If your dog is overwhelmed, the setup is too hard. Create distance first.

2 Lesson focus checklist

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Under threshold: can eat | ☐ Under threshold: can check in |
| ☐ Under threshold: can move away | ☐ Under threshold: can look and disengage |
| ☐ Under threshold: body is still somewhat loose | ☐ Over threshold: cannot eat |
| ☐ Over threshold: hard staring | ☐ Over threshold: barking |
| ☐ Over threshold: lunging | ☐ Over threshold: screaming |
| ☐ Over threshold: freezing | ☐ Over threshold: no response to known cues |

Supplies needed

- Front-clip harness
- Leash + backup
- High-value treats



PRACTICE · TRACK

3 Step-by-step practice plan

At a safe distance, offer a treat. Can your dog eat? That is under threshold.

Move 10 feet closer. Check again: eat, check in, or loose body?

Find today's working distance — the closest point where your dog can still eat.

Practice one skill at working distance for 2 minutes only.

Log where your dog went over threshold and how far you moved back.

4 Practice tracker

Date	Trigger	Distance	Can eat?	Next step
Day 1	Other dog	50 ft	Yes	Hold distance



REVIEW · REFLECT

5 Common mistakes to avoid

AVOID THESE

- Getting too close to triggers too fast.
- Tightening the leash at triggers.
- Practicing only on hard walks.

If this happens, try this

IF THIS HAPPENS, TRY THIS

Work on exercises outside triggers.
Back up before you make too close
signs of difficulty. Contact Fitdog if safety is a concern.

6 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I can explain "Thresholds" clearly.
- ☐ My dog stayed under threshold most of the week.
- ☐ I ended sessions while my dog could still succeed.
- ☐ My dog notices triggers and eats at working distance.

Practice one skill from "Thresholds" three times this week. Note what to simplify.

What went well?

When did my dog struggle?

Questions for my Fitdog trainer:

WELFARE / SAFETY

No forced greetings or punishment. Safety and distance support progress.